



SMBA Draft RFP Amendment 16 Industry Day

January 2026

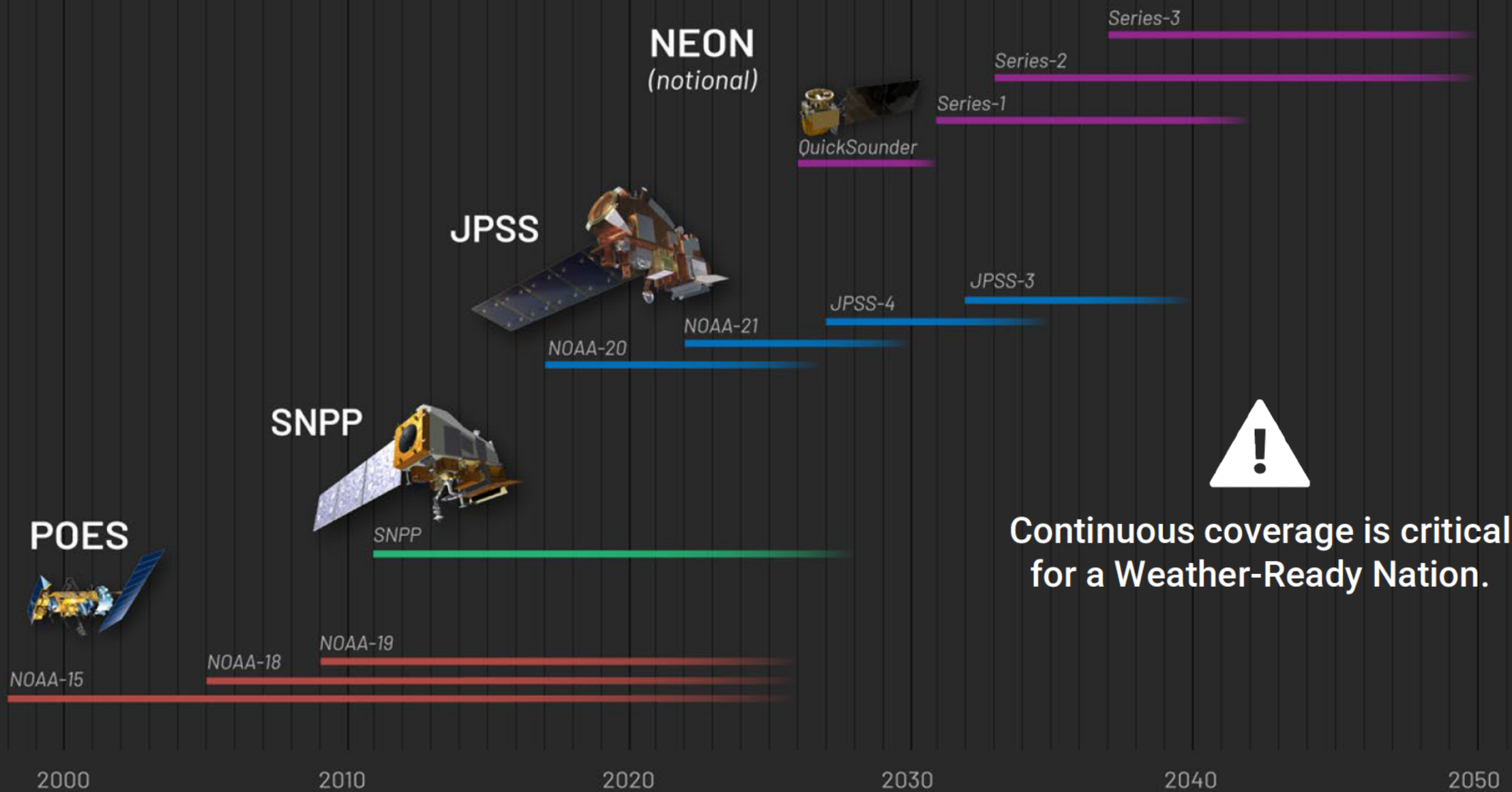


- Purpose: Provide an overview of and solicit feedback on SMBA's new single contract approach
 - Note: The final RFP is the next major drop. While there may be additional Industry Days and some smaller updates, no additional full dRFP update is planned.
- Agenda
 - Ground Rules
 - NEON Program, Series-1 Project, and SMBA Instrument Overview
 - SMBA RFP Updates
 - Feedback Solicited
 - Timeline
 - Questions

- The NEON team will continue to conduct one on ones with Industry Partners as requested until Black Out
 - Earlier feedback and discussions are most helpful
- Salient information will be provided to all Industry Partners
 - Questions will be posted anonymously
- The final chart deck from today will be posted on SAM.gov
- The Final Request for Proposal and its terms and conditions will supersede any statements in this document

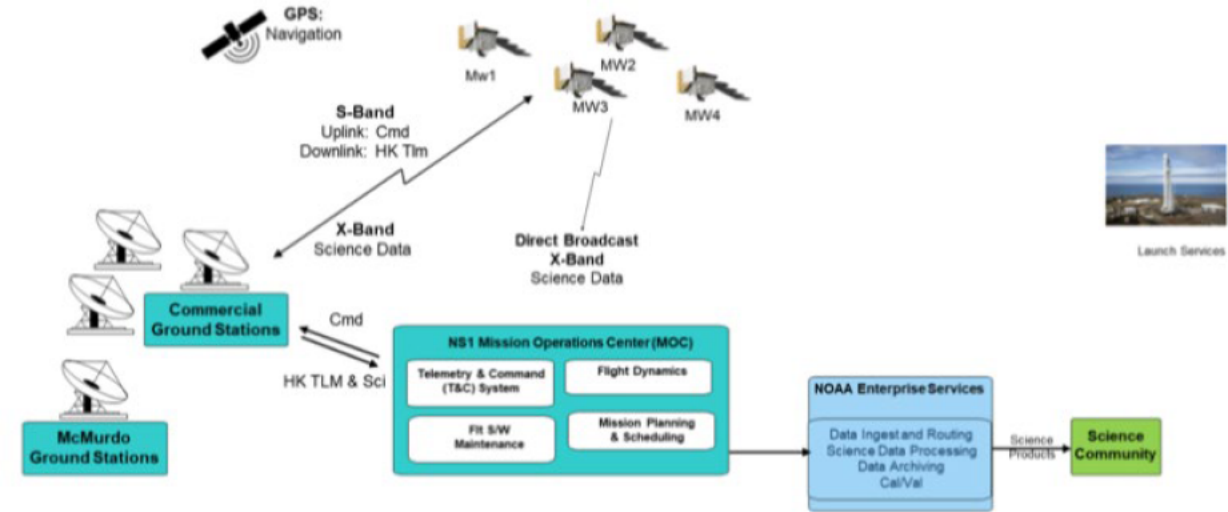
- The Near-Earth Orbit Network (NEON) Program was created by NOAA's National Environmental Satellite, Data and Information Service (NESDIS) to satisfy the mission need for global measurements to provide continuity to current Low Earth Orbit (LEO) measurements, while leveraging commercial advances in LEO satellite services.
- The NEON Program will field the next generation LEO observational capabilities to support the Department of Commerce's (DOC's) Primary Mission Essential Functions (PMEFs) and NOAA strategic objectives.
- NEON is the follow-on to the Joint Polar Satellite System (JPSS) and other NESDIS LEO observation endeavors. NEON will continue, improve, and extend NESDIS global observations for weather forecasting.
- NEON includes operations, maintenance, and sustainment over the program operational lifetime.

NOAA LEO Satellite Programs



Series-1 Architecture

- 4 Satellites, microwave sounders
- Mission Orbit
 - 824 km X 824 km, 98.7° inclination
 - Local Time: 13:30 & 17:30 (LTAN)
 - 63-month mission lifetime
- SMBA Instrument via industry RFP
- Satellite/MOC/GS/LV via industry RFP
- Category 2 or commercially equivalent launch vehicle
- Commercial Ground Station Services for Science uplink/downlink
- NOAA/NESDIS Enterprise Services for Science Product Production/Distribution/Archive



- All architectural elements acquired commercially*!
 - Instrument } New Development
 - Spacecraft } Bundled Mission Elements
 - Launch vehicle }
 - Mission operations }
 - Data Acquisition and Routing }
- Intercalibration targets are provided by the Government

*Note: This does not always imply FAR Part 12.

Contract Structure Updates

As of 01/05/26 – Final documents subject to change

1. Number of Contractors: Single Award
2. Down-Select: Eliminated
3. Contract Type: Cost Plus Fixed Fee (CPFF) through SMBA Flight Model (FM) 1 and Firm Fixed Price (FFP) for subsequent FMs
4. Additional Fee: Schedule Incentive for FM 1
5. Number of Units: Up to Eight
6. Contract Line Item Number (CLIN) Structure: To be determined (TBD)
7. Batching of work within CLINs (e.g., number of FMs, non-recurring engineering, engineering units, long lead items, etc...): TBD
8. Batching of CLINs within Core and Options: TBD

Other Contract and Programmatic Updates

As of 01/05/26 – Final documents subject to change

- Offerors will be expected to price the entire effort through FM 8
- A new funding profile is not yet available
- Moving from an Engineering Test Unit (ETU) to an Engineering Development Unit (EDU)
 - The EDU will be form, fit, function, and flight-like not flight-qualifiable
 - Upgrades to an ETU may be a pre priced change or option
- Past performance threshold will be lowered from \$250M

Industry Partner Feedback Themes: SoW and CDRL (1/2)

As of 12/22/25 – Final documents subject to change

Title	Details	Response
Approval by the Government	• Test data reviews • Class II changes • Gov't prescribed EPRs • Major reviews • Recommend limiting government access	• Removed oversight of test data reviews • Using notification and not requiring government approval • Contractor will submit EPR plan • Will retain government approval for IBR, SRR, PDR, CDR, PSR • Removed contractor hosted repository and removed "available on request" deliverables (if needed can rely on standard contract clauses allowing rights in data and inspections)
Critical Items	• Remove EVM • Reduce government involvement for subcontractors • Remove deliveries of EIADP for all components and only provide at instrument delivery	• EVM required for CP, but not for FFP • Gov't focus on critical subsystems per contractor proposed EPR plan • Delivery of full EIADP at instrument delivery & incremental delivery only for critical subsystems
Mission Assurance	• Comments to SOW were outdated – no substantial comments on review of updated SOW with MA requirements	• Incorporated the IMAR into SOW - Retained critical areas, while reducing the number of MA requirements by >75%
Commercial Practices	• BCR change threshold for notification is too low at \$250K • CCB – Recommend that Contractor not be a member in Govt. CCB & No government approval on Class II • Software – Should rely on commercial practices and not perform IV&V • CDRL/DID are too prescriptive - DID should rely more on Best Practices/Command Media	• Changed BCR threshold to \$500K • Retained contractor member of the CCB - Removed government approval on Class II • Removed 7150.2; use contractor processes in lieu of IV&V • Removed many NPRs and GPRs and re-wrote many DIDs to be less prescriptive

Industry Partner Feedback Themes: SoW and CDRL (2/2)

As of 12/22/25 – Final documents subject to change

Title	Details	Response
Uncertainty	• Recommend removing Cal Target from TVAC • Government provided target – need definition to accurately assess impact • Estimating resourcing for the proposal – Lack of definition • CDRL Update As Required (UAR) needs to be bounded	• Cal Target capability is required in TVAC • Gov't target technical information will be available from the CO upon request • Provided meeting and activity durations where practical & allow Contractor to propose approach and resolve in the proposal phase • UAR no longer used, changed the CDRL redelivery to significant changes only, no more "available on request" items in SOW or CDRL
Resident Office	• Do not need a resident office. Allow the Contractor to perform the work they understand and deliver to requirements.	• Defined the staffing and made the roles and purposes clearer.
Delineation Between Phase I and Phase II	• Do not want to address both phases of the contract in one SOW	• New contract structure. Applicable CLINs identified in SOW.

- Technical specifications are being updated to address Industry Partner responses from:
 - Draft RFP posted 4/18/2025 (NS1-SMBA-REQ-0001 Rev. B)
 - Draft RFP Amendment 13 posted 9/5/2025 (NS1-SMBA-REQ-0001 Rev. C)
- Another amendment will be posted soon with PRD Q&A that will share Government responses to Industry Partner feedback
 - Another Industry Day will be scheduled to discuss this in further detail

- When is the best time to switch from a Cost Plus contract to a Fixed Price contract?
- How does the new contract structure affect your approach?
- How does providing a price through FM8 with the proposal affect your approach?
 - In a single contract environment, what is the best way for the Government to get the best price while reducing uncertainty for Industry Partners?
- Which concerns do you have?
- What has the Government done well?

- Amendment 16 Industry Day – January 5, 2026
- One on Ones – Requested before January 7, 2026
 - Ongoing until RFP release
- RFP Release – Q1 CY 2026
- Proposals Due – 45 calendar days later
- Award – Q2 CY 2027

Discussion Continues to be Welcome Until Blackout at RFP Release!

Questions?

A stylized world map composed of glowing blue dots and connecting lines, set against a dark blue background. The map is centered on the Atlantic Ocean, with the continents of North and South America visible on the left and Europe and Africa on the right. The dots are of varying sizes and are connected by thin, light blue lines, creating a network-like effect. The overall aesthetic is futuristic and technological.